

Collects and Biographies for

Saints' Days & Festivals

of the Scottish Episcopal Calendar

July

Using this booklet

This booklet contains a short biography, and appropriate collects, for all saints and dated festivals within the Scottish Calendar published in 1996. It does not provide Post-Communion Prayers.

You may use the short biography as a preface to the Collect of the Day to introduce the life of the saint to the congregation, or as a short homily.

This booklet is arranged with one saint (or festival) to a page, giving details of the saint's day, its category (1-6) and the liturgical colour. Collects for use at a 1970 Scottish Liturgy (or 1929) Eucharist are given on the left, those for 1982 Scottish Liturgy on the right.

Notes

- Where feasts in Category 4 fall on a Sunday (other than a Sunday in Categories 1 and 2), they may, if local circumstances require, be kept on that day.
- When days in Category 6 coincide with a day of higher category, they should be omitted that year.

Key to Abbreviations

ASB	Alternative Service Book 1980 (Church of England)
Can	The Book of Alternative Services of The Anglican Church of Canada
CCP	Celebrating Common Prayer (Society of St Francis)
ECUSA	Episcopal Church of the United States of America
F	Black Letter Saints' Days (W.H. Frere; SPCK, 1961)
LFF	The proper for the Lesser Feasts and Fasts, 1991 (ECUSA)
MEG	Malcolm E. Grant, The Revd. Canon
R	The Roman Missal (1970)
SA	Anglican PB (Church of the Province of Southern Africa) 1989
SEC	Scottish Episcopal Church Alternative Collects
SPB	Scottish Prayer Book 1929

Credits

Originally compiled by the Reverend Canon Malcolm E. Grant, and used at the Cathedral of St Andrew, Inverness. This version was edited and repaginated by the Reverend Gareth J. M. Saunders, Edinburgh, June–October 2003. Additional material was taken from *Exciting Holiness*, Second Edition, 2003.

Version 2.2

1 JULY

Serf, Bishop (c.500) [6] *White*

Serf is one of the heroes of the Celtic Church known to us only through fragments of his story which are not always consistent. Tradition locates his activity at Culross and in the foothills of the Ochils, where he evangelised the Pictish tribe occupying the land to the north of the Forth. He is said to have been a disciple of Saint Palladius, and to have fostered and educated Saint Kentigern, which would place his activity in the first half of the 6th century.

1970 Scottish Liturgy

O heavenly Father,
Shepherd of thy people,
we give thee thanks
for thy servant Serf,
who was faithful in the care
and nurture of thy flock,
and laboured to spread
the good news of thy love;
and we pray that,
following his example
and the teaching of his holy life,
we may by thy grace
grow into the stature
of the fullness of our Lord
and Saviour Jesus Christ,
and witness to his great glory;
who liveth and reigneth
with thee and the Holy Spirit,
one God, for ever and ever.

(ECUSA – adapted)

1982 Scottish Liturgy

Heavenly Father,
Shepherd of your people,
we thank you for your servant Serf,
who was faithful in the care
and nurture of your flock,
and laboured to spread
the good news of your love;
and we pray that,
following his example
and the teaching of his holy life,
we may, by your grace,
grow into the stature
of the fullness of our Lord and
Saviour Jesus Christ,
and witness to his great glory;
who is alive and reigns with you
and the Holy Spirit,
for ever and ever.

(ECUSA – adapted)

3 JULY
(if not kept on 21 December)
Thomas, Apostle [4] Red

Thomas is mentioned among the number of the apostles in the gospels of Matthew, Mark and Luke but it is in John's gospel that his significance is revealed. First, he is heard encouraging the other disciples to go to Judea with Jesus; then, not knowing what Jesus meant when he talked about where he was to go elicited the answer that Jesus was himself the Way. But probably most famously was he the apostle notably unconvinced by reports of the resurrection of Jesus, causing Jesus to show him the marks in his hands and side. Thomas then acclaims the risen Christ with the words that have been described as the great climax to John's gospel: "My Lord and my God".

Nothing certain is known of his life after this, but there is a strong tradition that he went to India to preach the Gospel.

1970 Scottish Liturgy

Almighty and everliving God,
who for the more confirmation
of the faith
didst suffer thy holy Apostle Thomas
to be doubtful
in thy Son's resurrection:
grant us so perfectly,
and without all doubt,
to believe in thy Son Jesus Christ,
that our faith in thy sight
may never be reprov'd.
Hear us, O Lord,
through the same Jesus Christ,
to whom, with thee and the Holy
Ghost be all honour and glory, now
and for evermore.

(SPB)

1982 Scottish Liturgy

Almighty and eternal God,
who, for the firmer foundation
of our faith,
allowed your holy apostle Thomas
to doubt the resurrection of your Son
till word and sight convinced him:
grant to us, who have not seen,
that we also may believe
and so confess Christ as our Lord
and our God;
who is alive and reigns with you,
in the unity of the Holy Spirit,
one God, now and for ever.

(SEC)

6 JULY

Palladius, Bishop (c.450) [6] *White*

According to tradition, Palladius, a deacon at Rome but probably a native of Gaul, urged Pope Celestine to send Bishop Germanus of Auxerre to the British Isles to combat the Pelagian heresy, and was himself sent as bishop, two years later in 431, to continue this work.

He landed in Ireland before the beginning of Patrick's mission, and may have been expelled from Ireland after a short time, continuing his work in Scotland, where his name is linked with Airthrey, near Stirling, with which Saint Serf, possibly a disciple of his, is also associated, and with Fordoun in the Mearns, where he is said to have died. He is said to have been the teacher of Saint Ternan.

1970 Scottish Liturgy

O God, our heavenly Father,
who by thy Son Jesus Christ
didst call thy blessed Apostles
and send them forth
to preach thy Gospel of salvation
unto all the nations:
we bless thy holy Name
for thy servant Palladius,
whose labours
we commemorate this day,
and we pray thee,
according to thy holy Word,
to send forth many labourers
into thy harvest;
through the same
Jesus Christ our Lord.

(Can)

1982 Scottish Liturgy

God our Father,
you called us out of the darkness
of ignorance and error
into your own marvellous light,
and you gave us
your servant Palladius
to shine as a light in the world:
shine in our hearts, we pray,
and enable us to proclaim your love;
through Jesus Christ our Lord.
(SA – adapted)

7 JULY
Boisil, Prior of Melrose (c.642) [6] *White*

Boisil was Prior of Melrose in the middle of the 7th century, and Bede describes him as “a prophet and a very holy man”. His reputation attracted Cuthbert to Melrose, and he did much to encourage Cuthbert’s vocation. He died of the plague around the year AD 642, and it was Cuthbert who nursed him as he lay dying.

1970 Scottish Liturgy

O God,
whose blessed Son became poor
that we through his poverty
might be made rich:
deliver us, we pray thee,
from an inordinate love
of this world,
that, inspired by the devotion
of thy servant Boisil,
we may serve thee
with singleness of heart,
and attain to the riches
of the age to come;
through Jesus Christ our Lord.

(ECUSA)

1982 Scottish Liturgy

O God,
whose blessed Son became poor
that we through his poverty
might be made rich:
deliver us from an inordinate love
of this world,
that, inspired by the devotion
of your servant Boisil,
we may serve you
with singleness of heart,
and attain to the riches
of the age to come;
through Jesus Christ our Lord.
(ECUSA)

11 JULY
Benedict of Nursia, Abbot (c.550) [6] *White*

Born at Nursia in Umbria about the year AD 480, he studied in Rome, but he was horrified by the disturbed and profligate life-style he encountered there, and committed himself to a life of solitude in Subiaco, where disciples gathered around him. From these he organized 12 small communities, and then moved to Monte Cassino, where he established his famous monastery about the year 529. He drew up his Rule for this community, from which his grave, disciplined and compassionate character may be deduced. Known as the Father of Western monasticism, he died in 547.

1970 Scottish Liturgy

Almighty and everlasting God,
whose precepts
are the wisdom of a loving Father:
give us grace,
following the teaching
and example of thy servant Benedict,
to walk with loving and willing
hearts
in the school of the Lord's service;
let thine ears be open
unto our prayers,
and prosper with thy blessing
the work of our hands;
through Jesus Christ our Lord.
(ECUSA – LFF)

1982 Scottish Liturgy

Eternal God,
you made Saint Benedict
an outstanding master
in the school of your service:
grant that we may prefer your love
to everything else and seek with joy
the way of your commandments;
through Jesus Christ our Lord.
(CCP & R – adapted)

12 JULY
Drostan of Deer, Abbot (c.600) [6] *White*

Little is known of Drostan (Tristan). He is said to have been of royal stock, a nephew or companion of Saint Columba, with whom he visited Buchan, and who left him in charge of the new monastic foundation at Deer; but his name suggests he was of Pictish stock. His name occurs in many dedications in the North-East of Scotland. He seems also to have been venerated in Galloway and Glen Urquart.

1970 Scottish Liturgy

O God,
by whose grace
thy servant Drostan,
enkindled with the fire of thy love,
became a burning and a shining
light in thy Church:
grant that we also
may be aflame with the spirit
of discipline and love,
and may ever walk before thee
as children of light;
through Jesus Christ our Lord.

(ECUSA)

1982 Scottish Liturgy

Almighty God,
by whose grace Drostan,
kindled with the fire of your love,
became a burning and a shining
light in the Church:
in flame us with the same spirit
of discipline and love,
that we may ever walk before you
as children of light;
through Jesus Christ our Lord.
(ASB)

21 JULY

William Wilberforce (1833) [6] *White*

A native of Hull, and for a time its Member of Parliament, he is remembered chiefly for his part in the movement for the abolition of slavery, to which he devoted his energies and skills of oratory over almost half a century, and which was effected in the British dominions by an Act of Parliament passed just before his death in 1833.

After his conversion he determined to lead a strictly Christian life, and was persuaded by his friend John Newton to work out his Christian vocation in Parliament rather than in the ordained ministry. He became a prominent member of the Clapham Sect, helped in the foundation of the Church Missionary Society (CMS) and the Bible Society, championed the cause of Sunday observance, and defended Catholic Emancipation. His eloquence and charm, together with his profound religious spirit, made him a formidable power for good.

1970 Scottish Liturgy

O Lord and heavenly Father,
who didst claim William Wilberforce
for thy service
that thy children might be set free
from the shackles of slavery:
let thy Holy Spirit guide and inspire
all who serve this nation
with the same vision of liberty
and dignity for all,
and lead us all to that service
which is perfect freedom;
through Jesus Christ our Lord.

(MEG)

1982 Scottish Liturgy

God our deliverer,
who sent your Son Jesus Christ
to set your people free:
grant that as your servant
William Wilberforce
toiled for the freedom
of all the children of God,
so may we bring
your compassion
to the suffering,
the persecuted
and the oppressed;
through Jesus Christ our Lord.

(CCP)

22 JULY

Mary Magdalene [4] *White*

All four gospels give Mary Magdalene a unique place among Jesus's followers. Probably from Magdala by the Sea of Galilee, Mary Magdalene was one of a group of women who followed Jesus and ministered to his needs, and those of the Twelve. Her deep devotion to Jesus is often ascribed to His healing powers, which totally transformed her life, and some traditions identify her with a prostitute who found forgiveness and restoration of self-respect in the presence of our Lord.

The Gospels record Mary's presence at the death of Christ, and on the morning of Easter Day she was the first to whom the Risen Lord appeared and was told to take the good news of the resurrection to the other disciples. This commission earned her the title 'Apostle to the Apostles' in the early Church.

1970 Scottish Liturgy

O Almighty God,
whose blessed Son
did sanctify Mary Magdalene,
and did call her
to be a witness of his resurrection:
mercifully grant that by thy grace
we may be healed
of all our infirmities,
and always serve thee
in the power of his endless life;
who with thee and the Holy Ghost
liveth and reigneth one God,
world without end.

(SPB)

1982 Scottish Liturgy

Almighty God,
whose Son restored Mary Magdalene
to health of mind and body
and called her to be a witness
to his resurrection:
forgive our sins
and heal us by your grace,
that we may serve you
in the power of his risen life;
who is alive and reigns with you,
in the unity of the Holy Spirit,
one God, now and for ever.

(SEC)

25 JULY

James, Apostle [4] *Red*

James, often called 'the Great', a fisherman and brother of John, was one of the 'inner group' of disciples who were with Jesus at the Transfiguration, and the Agony in Gethsemane, as well as at certain miracles. He and his brother were nicknamed 'the Sons of Thunder', apparently in reference to their fiery disposition.

James expressed a willingness to share the cup of Christ's sufferings, and this was in fact realized when he became the first of the apostles to be martyred, being put to the sword by Herod Agrippa about the year AD 44.

1970 Scottish Liturgy

Grant, O merciful God,
that as thine holy apostle Saint
James,
leaving his father and all that he had,
without delay
was obedient unto the calling
of thy Son Jesus Christ,
and followed him;
so we, forsaking all
worldly and carnal affections,
may be evermore ready
to follow thy holy commandments;
through Jesus Christ our Lord.

(SPB)

1982 Scottish Liturgy

Merciful God,
whose holy apostle James
leaving his father and all that he had,
was obedient to the calling
of your Son Jesus Christ
and followed him even to death:
help us, forsaking the false
attractions of the world,
to be ready at all times
to answer your call without delay;
through Jesus Christ our Lord,
who is alive and reigns with you,
in the unity of the Holy Spirit,
one God, now and for ever.

(SEC)

26 JULY

Anne & Joachim, Parents of Mary, Mother of the Lord [6] *White*

In the proto-gospel of James, written in the middle of the second century, the parents of Mary the mother of Jesus are named as Anne and Joachim. The story there appears to be based heavily on that of Hannah, the mother of Samuel. We have no information about them in the Gospels, except that Mary is described as of Davidic descent, and must have been brought up in a devout Jewish home, where the hope of the coming Kingdom and deliverance was cherished.

Their place in the calendar shows the Church's desire to honour and strengthen parenthood as a vocation.

1970 Scottish Liturgy

Almighty God,
who didst confer such grace
on Saint Anne and Saint Joachim
that of them should be born
the mother
of thine only-begotten Son:
purify and illuminate
all whom thou hast made parents,
that they may bring up their children
in the knowledge of thy truth,
and dwell with them
in honour and love;
through Jesus Christ our Lord.

(F – adapted)

1982 Scottish Liturgy

Lord God of our fathers,
you bestowed upon
Saint Joachim and Saint Anne
this singular grace
that their daughter, Mary,
should become
the Mother of your Son,
our Saviour, Jesus Christ:
grant that we may all be made one
in his heavenly family,
and attain to the full joy
of the salvation
you promised to your people;
through the same
Jesus Christ our Lord.

(R & CCP – adapted)

29 JULY
Martha and Mary of Bethany [6] *White*

Martha and Mary appear in the Gospel as the sisters of Lazarus, whom Christ raised from the dead. Saint Luke records the story of their hospitality, from which Martha is remembered as a symbol of the active spiritual life, and Mary of the contemplative spiritual life. It is likely that their house was where our Lord stayed during visits to Jerusalem, and their friendship was obviously of deep value to Him.

1970 Scottish Liturgy

O God our heavenly Father,
whose Son Jesus Christ
enjoyed rest and refreshment
in the home of Mary and Martha
at Bethany:
give us the will to love thee,
open our hearts to hear thee,
and strengthen our hands to serve
thee in others;
for his sake who lives and reigns
with thee and the Holy Spirit,
one God, now and for ever.

(ECUSA – LFF – adapted)

1982 Scottish Liturgy

Loving Father,
your Son blessed with his presence
the home of Mary and Martha
and brought back their brother
from the grave:
make our homes
your dwelling place,
and raise us to newness of life;
through Jesus Christ our Lord.

(SA)

30 JULY
Silas, Companion of Saint Paul [6] *White*

Silas (or Silvanus) appears in the Acts of the Apostles and the New Testament Epistles as a companion and fellow-worker with Saint Paul. He was chosen by the Council of Jerusalem as ambassador to accompany Paul and Barnabas to Antioch with the Church's decision on the admission of Gentiles, was freed from jail in Philippi with Paul, and at Rome worked with both Paul and Peter. There is a tradition that he died in Macedonia.

1970 Scottish Liturgy

O Lord God,
who didst bless thy servant Silas
with the gift of prophecy
and madest him a faithful brother
of the holy apostles Peter and Paul:
in thine abundant goodness
give prophetic power
to all those whom thou dost call
to speak in the name of
Jesus Christ thy Son,
who now liveth and reigneth with
thee and the Holy Spirit one God
world without end.

(SA – adapted)

1982 Scottish Liturgy

Lord God,
you blessed Silas with the gift of
prophecy
and made him a faithful brother
of the apostles Peter and Paul:
give prophetic powers
to those you call
to speak in the name of Christ;
who is alive and reigns
with you and the Holy Spirit,
one God, for ever and ever.

(SA)

31 JULY

Ignatius Loyola, Priest and Religious (1556) [6] *White*

Born in 1491 at Loyola in northern Spain, the youngest son of a Basque nobleman, his early life was spent at court and in the army. After being wounded, he spent much time in sacred reading and was determined to consecrate his life to God's service.

He studied in Paris, where a group of students gathered around him. They bound themselves to go as missionaries to Palestine, but finding that war made that journey impossible they offered their services to the Pope, who assigned various tasks to them. In 1540 formal approval was given to their association, and the Society of Jesus came into being, with Ignatius as its director. His Spiritual Exercises have had enormous influence ever since, and his order became a powerful agency for missionary endeavour, and for reform within the Church. He died at Rome on this day in 1556.

1970 Scottish Liturgy

Teach us, good Lord,
after the example
of thy servant Ignatius,
to serve thee as thou deservest:
to give and not to count the cost;
to fight and not to heed the wounds;
to toil and not to seek for rest;
to labour
and not to ask for any reward,
save that of knowing
that we do thy will;
through Jesus Christ our Lord.

(from Saint Ignatius Loyola)

1982 Scottish Liturgy

Teach us, good Lord,
after the example
of your servant Ignatius,
to serve you as you deserve:
to give, and not to count the cost;
to fight and not to heed the wounds;
to toil and not to seek for rest;
to labour
and not to ask for any reward,
save that of knowing
that we do your will;
through Jesus Christ our Lord.

(from Saint Ignatius Loyola)

July

1	Serf, Bishop, c.550	6	White
2	—	—	—
3	Thomas, Apostle (if not kept on 21 December)	4	Red
4	—	—	—
5	—	—	—
6	Palladius, Bishop, c.450	6	White
7	Boisil, Prior of Melrose, c.642	6	White
8	—	—	—
9	—	—	—
10	—	—	—
11	Benedict of Nursia, Abbot, c.550	6	White
12	Drostan of Deer, Abbot, c.600	6	White
13	—	—	—
14	—	—	—
15	—	—	—
16	—	—	—
17	—	—	—
18	—	—	—
19	—	—	—
20	—	—	—
21	William Wilberforce, 1833	6	White
22	Mary Magdalene	4	White
23	—	—	—
24	—	—	—
25	James, Apostle	4	Red
26	Anne and Joachim, Parents of Mary, Mother of the Lord	6	White
27	—	—	—
28	—	—	—
29	Martha and Mary of Bethany	6	White
30	Silas, Companion of Saint Paul	6	White
31	Ignatius Loyola, Priest and Religious, 1556	6	White